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BLACK HISTORY MONTH

Just the facts – online, daily

In 1865, John Sweat Rock (1825-1866), a noted Boston lawyer, became the first African-American to practice before the U.S. Supreme Court and the first black person to speak before the U.S. House of Representatives.

Since in 1997, Black Facts Online has shared its growing database of black history information with the Internet community and delivered historical facts, such as John Sweat Rock's accomplishments, to households around the world via E-mail.

Said to be the world's largest online database of searchable black history, Black Facts Online allows users to find historical information by date and through keyword searches. With a free subscription, Black Facts will send a bit of black history to an E-mail address every morning.

Black Facts Online was created by Inner-City Software of Dorchester, Mass. – a one-man operation founded by Ken Granderson in 1994.

The company has a commitment to develop and bring information technology to local neighborhoods. Its projects have included an interactive CD-ROM chronicling Boston's black history and building and hosting Web sites.

Black Facts Online, built by Inner-City Software's fist programmer Martin Welch, was established six years ago.

The Black Facts information is provided by research associates who enter the facts and other information into the databases. To ensure the quality of the information, the submitted data is held until a historian can verify it.

Inner-City Software depends on corporate sponsorship, donations, grants and advertisements to maintain the Web site. Research associates volunteer their services.

To sign up for Black Facts Online or volunteer as a research associate, visit the company's Web site: www.blackfacts.com.

– Lester Hinds

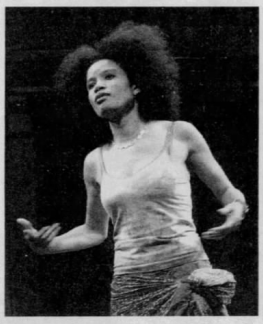
'Def Poets' are in the tradition

The rhymes of rap music and hip-hop artists have put poetry and spoken word in the spotlight like never before. And Russell Simmons' Def Jam Poetry on HBO and his "Def Jam Poetry on Broadway" have played their parts in the comeback of spoken word performance.

Early African-American poets, such as Phillis Wheatley, were slaves who wrote on religious themes. And post- Civil War poets, such as Paul Lawrence Dunbar, avoided racial injustice in their works.

But over the years – through the Harlem Renaissance, the 1960s and 1970s – black poetry evolved and tackled currents affairs, social injustices and other topics.

African-American poets – along with an ethnic rainbow of performers – take on issues ranging from racism to sexism in the Def Jam poetry productions.



Poet Stacyann Chin

"Russell Simmons Presents, Def Poetry" is in its third season on HBO, airing Friday nights. Visit www.hbo.com for show times.

Def Jam Poetry on Broadway is running at the Longacre Theater, 220 W. 48th St. in Manhattan. For tickets, call Telecharge at (212)239-6200.

For information about Def Jam Poetry, visit www.defpoetryjam.com.

BLACK HISTORY MONTH

OUR CELEBRATION OF CULTURE AND CREATIVITY CONTINUES AT HERALD SQUARE!

JOIN US FOR A WEEK-LONG TRIBUTE TO MUSIC LEGENDS IN MEN'S ON 3



MONDAY, FEBRUARY 10 AT 1PM: N-CODED **MUSIC** recording artist, guitarist **Ronny Jordan and his trio** perform some of today's hottest contemporary jazz with their signature blend of fluid jazz and hip hop cool!

TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 11 AT 1PM: Author **Fikisha Cumbo** joins us to autograph your purchase of her book ***GET UP! STAND UP! DIARY OF A REGGAEOPHILE***, chronicling the lives of Bob Marley and Peter Tosh. Plus, enjoy the progressive roots sounds of **Tropical Groove**, comprised of New York's and Jamaica's top reggae musicians, including Junior Jazz!



TUESDAY, FEBRUARY 11 AT 6PM: Mapleshade recording artists **The Sugar Hill Quartet** add their brilliant, energetic sounds to the music of the one and only Duke Ellington courtesy of American Legacy Magazine!



WEDNESDAY, FEBRUARY 12 AT 1PM: American Legacy Magazine brings us jazz vocalist **Tiffany Hall,** who'll take time off from the Harlem Jazz circuit to pay musical tribute to the great ladies of song, Sarah Vaughn and Billie Holiday!

FRIDAY, FEBRUARY 14 AT 1PM: Drummer **TS Monk, Jr.**, son of the late Thelonius Monk and an accomplished Jazz artist in his own right, pays homage to his father, Miles Davis and other legendary musicians.



Ronny Jordan, Fikisha Cumbo and TS Monk, Jr. appearances sponsored by the GTD Entertainment and Sports Foundation.



AN AFTERNOON FOR KIDS WITH AUTHOR FAITH RINGGOLD!

Saturday, February 15 at 1pm in Kids on 7. Learn about the inspiring life of Rosa Parks, the "mother of the Civil Rights movement" when award-winning artist and author Faith Ringgold reads from her enchanting new book ***IF A BUS COULD TALK: THE STORY OF ROSA PARKS***! Beautifully illustrated with her magnificent artwork, Faith will autograph your purchase of her book! While you're here, be sure to see some of Faith's gorgeous one-of-a-kind quilts, on display in our **art exhibit on 8 through February 17**.



IT'S YOUR LAST WEEK TO SEE OUR SATELLITE EXHIBIT OF THE NATIONAL BLACK FINE ART SHOW! From painting to sculpture and more, our special exhibit includes works by some of the artists and galleries that were featured at the NBFAS. **Through February 16, on 8.**

NOW STARRING AT macy's HERALD SQUARE

Events subject to change or cancellation.

7 SPECIALCS DAILY NEWS Sunday, February 9, 2003

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